

Order of Operations

GEMDAS

The Steps (GEMDAS)

1 G
Grouping symbols
(), []

2 E
Exponents

3 MD
Multiply & Divide
left → right

4 AS
Add & Subtract
left → right

Worked Example

$$3 + 2 \times (5 - 1)^2$$

1 $3 + 2 \times (4)^2$

✓ Evaluate grouping symbols:
 $5 - 1 = 4$

2 $3 + 2 \times 16$

✓ Evaluate exponents:
 $4^2 = 16$

3 $3 + 32$

✓ Multiply (left to right):
 $2 \times 16 = 32$

4 35

✓ Add (left to right):
 $3 + 32 = 35$



Multiply/Divide and Add/Subtract go left to right — not M before D.

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$$3 + 32$$

✓ Multiply (left to right):
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$$35$$

✓ Add (left to right):
 $3 + 32 = 35$



Multiply/Divide and Add/Subtract go left to right — not M before D.